

Word family: **nature / natural / naturally / naturalist / naturalism**

Base word: nature

Related forms: natural, naturally, naturalist, naturalism

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related adjective and adverb forms (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “It reminded me that **nature** does not need to be loud to be powerful.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **nature** means the **natural world — animals, plants, landscapes, seas, weather, and other things that exist without being created by humans**.

繁體中文： **自然界；由動植物、海洋、山川、天氣等非人工事物組成的自然世界**

中文翻譯：

> “It reminded me that **nature** does not need to be loud to be powerful.”

「這提醒了我，**大自然**不需要喧鬧，也可以非常有力量。」

Here:

nature = 大自然 / 自然界

1. **nature = the natural world (自然界) — 大自然；自然界**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The physical world and everything in it that develops or exists without being made by humans.

Practice 1 — Original

> “**Nature** does not need to be loud to be powerful.”

「**大自然**不需要喧鬧，也可以非常有力量。」

Practice 2

> “She loves spending time in **nature**.”

「她喜歡在**大自然**中度過時間。」

Practice 3

> “The documentary explores the beauty of **nature**.”

「這部紀錄片探索**自然界**的美。」

****nature = 動物、植物、海洋、山川、天氣及其他非人工環境所構成的自然世界****

Common:

- * protect nature
- * enjoy nature
- * in nature
- * nature reserve
- * beauty of nature

2. ****nature = basic character / essential qualities (本質) — 本質；性質；特性****

****Nature**** can mean the fundamental character or essential qualities of something.

Practice 4

> “We need to understand the true ****nature**** of the problem.”

「我們需要了解這個問題的真正****本質****。」

Practice 5

> “The exact ****nature**** of the damage is still unclear.”

「損壞的具體****性質****仍然不清楚。」

****nature = 某件事物最根本的特性、本質或基本性質****

Common:

- * nature of the problem
- * nature of the relationship
- * nature of the work
- * true nature

This is a major distinct abstract sense.

3. **nature** = a person's character/personality (性格) — 性格；本性；天性

Nature can refer to a person's natural character or temperament.

Practice 6

> “She has a generous **nature**.”

「她有一種慷慨的**性格 / 天性**。」

Practice 7

> “He is quiet by **nature**.”

「他**天性**比較安靜。」

nature = 一個人較根本、自然形成的性格或氣質

Common:

- * kind nature
- * gentle nature
- * by nature
- * human nature

This is closely related to Meaning 2, but for learners it is useful to display separately because it specifically concerns **personality/temperament**.

4. **nature** = natural tendency / instinct (天性 / 本能) — 天性；本能傾向

Nature can also mean an innate tendency rather than something learned.

Practice 8

> “It is in his **nature** to help others.”

「幫助別人是他的**天性**。」

Practice 9

> “Curiosity seems to be part of human **nature**.”

「好奇心似乎是人類**天性**的一部分。」

****nature = 與生俱來、不是後天刻意學習形成的傾向或特質****

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3 under the broader ****character/innate disposition**** sense.

5. ****nature = type/kind of something (種類 / 性質) — 性質 ; 類型****

In more formal English, ****of a ... nature**** means “of a particular kind or character.”

Practice 10

> “The problems were mainly financial in ****nature****.”

「這些問題的****性質****主要是財務方面的。」

Practice 11

> “They discussed matters of a personal ****nature****.”

「他們討論了一些屬於私人****性質****的事情。」

****of a particular nature = 屬於某種性質、類別或特點的****

This develops from Meaning 2 and usually does not need a separate core category.

6. ****Nature = force/order governing the natural world (自然規律 / 自然力量) — 自然 ; 自然規律****

Sometimes ****nature**** refers to the processes, forces, or order operating in the natural world.

Practice 12

> “The building was slowly reclaimed by ****nature****.”

「那棟建築慢慢被****大自然****重新吞沒。」

Practice 13

> “You cannot completely control the forces of ****nature****.”

「你不可能完全控制**自然力量**。」

****nature = 自然界中自行運作的力量、規律和過程****

For core counting, I would usually keep this under Meaning 1.

Related form: ****natural****

****Natural**** has several important meanings.

****natural = existing in nature, not artificial (天然的) ****

Practice 14

> “The beach has preserved much of its ****natural**** beauty.”

「這個海灘保留了很多****天然的 / 自然的****美。」

****natural = 由自然形成，而不是人工製造或改造的****

****natural = normal / expected (自然的；正常的) ****

Practice 15

> “It is ****natural**** to feel nervous before an exam.”

「考試前感到緊張是很****自然 / 正常****的。」

****natural = 符合一般人性、情況或發展規律，因此不令人意外的****

****natural = innate, not learned (天生的) ****

Practice 16

> “She has a ****natural**** talent for music.”

「她有****天生的****音樂天分。」

****natural = 與生俱來，而不是後天訓練形成的****

Related form: **naturally**

Naturally has several useful functions.

naturally = in a natural way (自然地)

Practice 17

> “The plant grows **naturally** in this region.”

「這種植物在這個地區**自然生長**。」

naturally = of course / as expected (當然 ; 自然地)

Practice 18

> “Naturally, she was disappointed.”

「**當然 / 不出所料地**，她感到失望。」

This second use is especially important because **naturally** can function as a discourse adverb meaning:

> **as one would expect**

Related form: **naturalist**

A **naturalist** is a person who studies or observes plants, animals, and the natural world.

Practice 19

> “The **naturalist** spent years studying local wildlife.”

「那位**博物學家 / 自然觀察者**花多年研究本地野生動物。」

naturalist = 研究或觀察自然界、動植物的人

Related form: **naturalism**

Naturalism has specialized meanings in philosophy, art, and literature.

Practice 20

> “The novel is often discussed in relation to literary **naturalism**.”

「這本小說常被放在文學**自然主義**的脈絡中討論。」

This is established but specialized, so I would keep it as a lower-priority lexical-family extension rather than part of the main learner core.

Important distinction: **nature vs environment**

nature

= the natural world itself

environment

= the surroundings or conditions in which people, animals, plants, etc. live

> protect nature

> protect the environment

They overlap, but **environment** can also include human-made surroundings.

Important distinction: **nature vs character**

For people:

nature

often suggests deeper, more innate personality.

character

can refer more broadly to personality, moral qualities, or distinctive traits.

> “He has a gentle nature.”

= 他天性溫和。

> “He has strong character.”

= 他意志 / 品格堅強。

Important distinction: **nature vs personality**

personality

describes the overall pattern of how someone thinks, feels, and behaves socially.

nature

often sounds more fundamental or innate.

> outgoing personality

> kind nature

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: **nature vs essence**

essence

means the most fundamental defining quality of something.

nature

is broader and can mean the general type, character, or inherent qualities.

> true nature of the problem

≈

> essence of the problem

but **essence** is usually more abstract and concentrated.

Important distinction: **natural vs normal**

natural

can mean arising naturally or expected according to human/natural tendencies.

****normal****

means conforming to what is usual or typical.

- > natural reaction
- > normal temperature

They overlap, but are not identical.

Important distinction: ****natural vs artificial****

This is a core contrast.

****natural****

= formed by nature or occurring without artificial creation

****artificial****

= made or produced by humans to imitate or replace something natural

- > natural light
- > artificial light

Countability note

****Nature**** is usually uncountable in its major meanings:

- > nature
- > human nature
- > the nature of the problem

Not normally:

- > a nature

But it can be countable when referring to a person's particular disposition in some contexts:

- > "He has a gentle nature."

Even here, it usually appears as:

> a + adjective + nature

rather than simply “a nature.”

Useful expression: **by nature — 天性上；本來**

Practice 21

> “She is cautious by **nature**.”

「她**天性上**比較謹慎。」

Practice 22

> “He is generous by **nature**.”

「他**天性**慷慨。」

by nature = 因天生性格如此，而不是後天刻意形成

Useful expression: **in the nature of something — 屬於……的性質**

Practice 23

> “Some uncertainty is in the **nature** of scientific research.”

「某程度的不確定性是科學研究**本身性質的一部分**。」

This belongs to the essence/character sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **nature**

* **natural**

* **naturally**

* **naturalist**
* **naturalism**

Useful constructions include:

* nature
* human nature
* true nature
* nature of the problem
* by nature
* natural environment
* natural talent
* naturally occurring

The Golden Manual says useful family forms, figurative meanings, and domain extensions should be included, but closely related contexts should be merged when the same underlying mental concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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nature — natural world	由動植物、海洋、山川、天氣等非人工事物構成的自然世界
nature — essential character	某件事物最根本的特性、本質或基本性質
nature — person's character	一個人較根本、自然形成的性格、氣質或天性
nature — type/kind	某件事情所屬的性質或類型；通常屬於 essential-character 義
natural	天然的；自然形成的；正常自然的；天生的
naturally	自然地；亦可表示「當然 / 不出所料地」
naturalist	研究或觀察自然界、動植物的人
naturalism	自然主義；專門哲學 / 藝術 / 文學詞彙

For your original sentence

> “It reminded me that **nature** does not need to be loud to be powerful.”

The exact meaning is:

nature = 整個自然界 / 大自然

So:

> **nature does not need to be loud to be powerful**

= **大自然不需要以喧鬧、戲劇化的方式出現，也可以展現強大的力量**

Here, **nature** refers collectively to the natural world, with the sea turtle serving as the immediate example.

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **nature**:

1. **the natural world**
2. **the essential character or fundamental qualities of something**
3. **a person's innate character, temperament, or tendency**

I would merge **of a ... nature** into #2, merge **human nature / by nature** into #3, and keep **natural / naturally / naturalist / naturalism** as family extensions rather than inflate the base-word count.